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Rules Conventions

How it works

Follow the instructions on cards and components. When a specific rule conflicts with a general rule, the specific rule wins. Do as much of an instruction as possible unless the missing part is a required cost, requirement, or target.

Complete rules

- **May** indicates an optional effect. **Must** indicates a required effect.
- Resolve instructions in the order written unless another rule establishes a different order.
- When a card, Leader, faction, Territory, or supplemental-component rule conflicts with a general rule, follow the specific rule.
- Card text changes a card's normal destination only to the extent stated.
- If an instruction cannot be completed in full, complete as much as possible unless the uncompleted instruction is a required cost, requirement, or target.
- An effect resolves only at its stated timing. Revealing a card early does not cause a later portion of its effect to resolve early.
- An effect cannot be canceled or negated after it has resolved.

Playing cards

A card may have several printed effects. The way the card enters play determines which effect is used.

- **Action:** play during an Action Opportunity.
- **Gambit:** set only as a Gambit.
- **Tactic:** choose only as a Tactic.
- **Battle:** use as either a Gambit or Tactic.
- **Mission:** use only as instructed by Intelligence rules.

Faction guides and individual cards may define additional printed headings, such as **Terms**, **Asset**, **Overlay**, **Loan**, or **Effect**. Those headings use the timing and procedure stated by their governing text. They do not make a card eligible as a Gambit or Tactic unless the card also has an eligible Gambit, Tactic, or Battle effect.

Playing a card for one printed effect does not activate its other printed effects unless a rule says otherwise.

Setting a Gambit or choosing a Tactic places the card in battle. It does not resolve immediately unless stated. A face-up Gambit or Tactic still waits for its normal reveal timing unless an effect says otherwise.

Heresy and copied effects

Heresy follows the shared copied-effect rule but retains permission for one additional copied-effect layer. That additional effect cannot create another layer. The selected Graveyard card remains there.

For a sliding tracker, place the indicated Leader or Reference Card over the tracker. Fully cover the tracker at 0, then slide the covering card until its bottom edge aligns with the current value.

- A counter, dial, written record, or other substitute may be used when it shows the same public information clearly and unambiguously.
- A reference card is a reminder, not a separate rules authority. If its shortened text omits a detail, follow this rulebook and the definitive faction guide.
- A double-sided supplemental card changes state only when its governing rule tells you to flip it. Keep any attached or bound cards with it so both players can identify the relationship.
- Supplemental components have no deckbuilding value and are not eligible as Gambits, Tactics, costs, collateral, Transmutation cards, Treasury cards, or other playable cards unless a rule explicitly says otherwise.
- Each player supplies and controls their own faction package unless a faction rule identifies a shared supply. In a mirror match, keep the two players' components separated and oriented toward their owners.

Military package

Use the selected Leader Card and the **Command Tracker**. Begin at 0 Command with the tracker fully covered by the Leader. Slide the Leader to 1 or 2 whenever Command changes. The Leader Card lists that Leader's three Orders; spend Command only at an Order's stated timing.

Diplomat package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Influence Tracker**, double-sided **Diplomat Reference Card**, and nine double-sided **Proposal / Treaty Article cards**. Begin at 1 Influence and place every Proposal with its Proposal side up. Lower the tracker when Influence is staked or spent and raise it when Influence returns or is gained. Flip an unratified Proposal to its Treaty Article side only when it is ratified. Leave ratified Articles face up so progress toward the Peace Treaty is public.

Financier package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Financier Reference Card**, public **Capital Ledger**, and eight identical **Deed Cards** in a shared supply. Begin with 0 Capital and an empty Treasury. Record every Capital gain, spend, loss, and end-turn reduction as a new Ledger transaction with a running Balance. When a Deed is bought, place one Deed Card beside its Territory on the owner's side; move it during a buyout and return it to the supply if it becomes unowned. A Deed is not an Asset or Overlay.

Intelligence package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Mission Reference Card**, **Operations Reference Card**, **Intel Tracker**, and **Operation Progress Tracker**. Both tracked values begin at 0 and have no maximum. Place the Intel Tracker beneath the Operations Reference and the Operation Progress Tracker beneath the Mission Reference, then slide the covering card to the current value. Record values beyond the printed track separately. An Active Mission or Special Operation is an eligible card from the Playable Deck placed face down near the Leader; the reference cards themselves never become Missions.

Mystics package

Use the selected Leader Card, **Mystics Reference Card**, and the three double-sided **Rite cards**: Rite of Echoes, Rite of Blood, and Rite of Crossing. Begin with every Rite incomplete-side up. Keep a begun Rite and any cards bound to it together. Flip the Rite when it is completed; reset it to the incomplete side when

Grand Inquisitor



Archetype: Judgment, Purge, and permanent removal

Motto: *We judge. We purge.*

Final Judgment: Once per turn, during the Aftermath of a battle you won, after cards follow their destinations, you may immediately Purge without using an Action Opportunity. Reduce that Purge's Conviction cost by 1, to a minimum of 1.

The normal Conviction gain from that battle may resolve before Final Judgment.

2. Building a Deck

How it works

Choose one faction and one of its two Leaders. Build a Playable Deck of at least 30 cards with no more than 60 total deckbuilding value. Use Neutral cards and cards from your chosen faction. Then choose three different Territories.

Complete rules

Choose a faction and Leader

Choose one faction, then choose one Leader belonging to that faction. Both players may choose the same faction or Leader.

The Leader Card begins face up and remains available throughout the game.

Build the Playable Deck

A Playable Deck must contain:

- at least **30 cards**;
- no more than **60 total deckbuilding value**; and
- only Neutral cards and cards belonging to the selected faction.

Unless marked **Unique**, a card may appear in any quantity permitted by the available card pool. A Unique card is limited to one copy in the Playable Deck.

Choose Territories

Choose exactly three different Territory Cards.

- No more than one may be an **Arena**.
- Territory Cards are not part of the Playable Deck.
- Territories do not count toward the 30-card minimum or 60-value maximum.
- Both players may choose the same Territory titles.

Supplemental components

Prepare all components required by the chosen faction and Leader.

Unless a rule says otherwise, supplemental components:

- are not part of the Playable Deck;
- are not shuffled into the Draw Pile;
- cannot be drawn, played, discarded, banked, or placed in the Graveyard; and
- do not count toward deck size or deckbuilding value.

Conviction, doctrine, Purge, and Purification

How it works

The first time opposing cards enter the Graveyard during the Aftermath of a battle involving you each turn, gain 1 Conviction. Opposing Tactics go there instead of the Discard Pile, making battle choices more costly against the Inquisition.

During an Action Opportunity, spend Conviction on one Purge instead of playing an Action card.

Complete rules

Conviction

Conviction: Maximum 4. The first time each turn one or more opposing cards enter the Graveyard during the Aftermath of a battle involving you, gain 1 Conviction.

- This may occur during either player's turn.
- Several qualifying cards from the same battle still produce only 1 normal gain.
- Winning is not required.
- Conviction above 4 is lost.

Condemnation

Condemnation: During the Aftermath of battles involving you, opposing Tactics go to their owner's Graveyard instead of their Discard Pile.

Opposing Gambits already go to the Graveyard normally. Cards remaining in the opponent's Reserve are discarded normally.

Blasphemy

Blasphemy: Whenever an opponent plays a card with the Arcane trait for its Action effect, or an Arcane Gambit or Tactic they control is revealed, gain 1 Conviction.

This gain is outside the normal once-per-turn Conviction gain but cannot exceed 4. An Arcane card resolved only through a copied effect is not played or revealed as a Gambit or Tactic and does not trigger Blasphemy unless the effect says otherwise. Arcane is a trait, not faction allegiance.

Purge

During an Action Opportunity, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, spend Conviction to perform one Purge:

4. Turn Structure

How it works

On your turn, first capture an opposing Territory you held through the opponent's turn. Then draw a card. You may take one Action either before or after movement. During movement, advance, hold, or withdraw. Resolve any battle immediately. Finally, discard down to three cards.

A battle ends the movement that started it. You move again afterward only when a rule or card specifically permits it.

Complete rules

Complete each turn in this order:

1. **Capture**
2. **Draw**
3. **Action Opportunity before movement**
4. **Movement**
5. **Action Opportunity after movement**
6. **Cleanup**

Capture

At the start of the turn, if the active player occupies a Territory they do not control, they capture it by rotating the Territory to face them.

Resolve effects and victory checks that occur after the Capture step before drawing.

Draw

Draw one card.

If the Draw Pile cannot complete a draw, shuffle the Discard Pile to form a new Draw Pile and continue. If the Draw Pile and Discard Pile cannot provide the full draw, draw as many cards as possible. Cards already drawn during that draw are not shuffled back.

Action Opportunities

The active player has one normal Action Opportunity each turn. It may be used before movement or, if unused, after movement.

During an Action Opportunity, the player may:

- play one card for its Action effect; or
- perform one rule or faction action that explicitly uses an Action Opportunity.

An additional Action Opportunity permits one additional qualifying action at the stated timing. It does not grant movement unless stated.

Repeating Battle effects

Witchcraft and similar effects follow the shared copied-effect rules. A repeat effect cannot choose another repeat or card-adding effect unless it expressly permits one additional layer.

5. Movement

How it works

During movement, you may move one position toward the opponent, remain where you are, or move one position toward your own end. Entering the opponent's position starts a battle.

A battle stops the current movement. Winning does not automatically let you continue moving; follow-up movement must come from an Order, card, or other specific effect.

Complete rules

A **position** is any location a Player Token may occupy:

- each Territory;
- the position immediately before either end of the Gauntlet; and
- the position immediately beyond either end.

During the Movement step, choose one:

- **Advance:** move one position toward the opponent's end.
- **Hold:** remain in the current position.
- **Withdraw:** move one position toward your own end.

A player cannot voluntarily withdraw beyond their own end. Player Tokens cannot move through or past one another.

If an effect grants additional movement, resolve it one position at a time unless stated otherwise. Entering an occupied position begins a battle. When that happens, the current movement sequence ends and any remaining movement is lost.

Entering an occupied Territory

Move the attacking token into the contested Territory before the battle. During the unresolved battle, the defender remains the occupant. If the attacker wins, the defender retreats and the attacker becomes the occupant.

Movement after battle

A player moves after a battle only when a rule or effect explicitly permits it. That movement is a new movement sequence and may start a new battle if the effect allows it.

Alchemist



Archetype: Sacrifice sequencing and card conversion

Motto: *Nothing is fixed. Everything can be transformed.*

Materia Prima: The first time on your turn that you put a card from your Hand in your Graveyard as part of a Rite, Transmutation, or an Arcane card effect, draw one card. If this occurs during a battle, draw after the Aftermath of the battle.

A Gambit entering the Graveyard during normal destinations does not trigger Materia Prima merely because it came from Hand.

3. Form Reserves

Each player sets their Hand physically aside, then draws three cards to form a **Reserve**.

- The set-aside cards remain in Hand.
- A player may inspect and arrange their own Reserve freely.
- The Reserve is hidden from the opponent and separate from the Hand.
- Effects may modify the number of cards drawn.

4. Reveal Gambits

Reveal all Gambits simultaneously.

Effects that expressly resolve before other Gambit effects resolve first. After that, resolve remaining Gambit effects using the shared-timing rule below.

A face-up Gambit that was revealed early remains in battle and resolves at this stage unless its text says otherwise.

5. Choose Tactics

Unless an effect changes the order:

1. the attacker chooses up to one eligible Tactic from Reserve face down or passes;
2. the defender chooses up to one eligible Tactic from Reserve face down or passes.

A card with a **Tactic** or **Battle** effect is eligible.

6. Reveal Tactics

Reveal all Tactics simultaneously. Resolve their effects using the shared-timing rule.

A face-up Tactic revealed early remains in battle and waits for this stage unless its text says otherwise.

7. Resolve the battle

Resolve all effects that occur before dice are rolled. Then each player normally rolls one six-sided die.

Advantage and disadvantage

Combine all instances of advantage and disadvantage. They cancel one-for-one.

- For each net advantage, roll one additional die and use the highest result.
- For each net disadvantage, roll one additional die and use the lowest result.

After selecting the die result, resolve rerolls and changes to the die result in their specified order. Then apply numerical modifiers to determine the battle total.

Determine the winner

The higher battle total wins.

Defender's Advantage: This is a tie rule, not an instance of the ordinary advantage mechanic. If battle totals are tied and the defender controls the contested Territory, the defender wins. Defender's Advantage does not grant an additional die. It also applies during a Last Stand battle, so the defender wins tied Last Stand battle totals even though no Territory is contested there.

Completion: On a later turn, complete this Rite when another card with the bound Hand card's title resolves its Gambit, Tactic, or Battle effect during a battle.

On completion:

- move the selected Graveyard card to your Discard Pile;
- put the bound Hand card in your Graveyard;
- resolve the completing card normally; and
- flip Rite of Echoes to its completed side.

If you lose a battle before completion, put both bound cards in your Graveyard and reset the Rite.

Rite of Blood

Beginning cost: Put one card from your Hand in your Graveyard.

Completion: On a later turn, complete this Rite when you win a battle without setting a Gambit or choosing a Tactic.

Using Transmutation, an Asset, Overlay, Territory, Leader ability, or card from another source does not by itself prevent completion.

If you lose a battle before completion, reset the Rite.

Rite of Crossing

You may begin this Rite only during an Action Opportunity after movement after winning a battle that caused you to occupy a Territory the opponent controlled immediately before that battle.

Beginning cost: Put one Arcane card from your Hand in your Graveyard. If you have none, reveal your Hand and move one Arcane card from your Discard Pile to your Graveyard instead.

Completion: At the start of your next turn, after the Capture step, complete this Rite if you still occupy or control that Territory. Otherwise, the Rite is interrupted and resets.

Ritual of Ascendancy and Convergence

How it works

After completing all three Rites, use an Action Opportunity after movement to bind one Arcane card from your Hand, one from your Discard Pile, and one from your Graveyard. This begins the Ritual.

Initiate a battle while all three remain bound. Convergence adds +1 for each Ritual card. Win that battle to win the game. Lose any battle before completion and the Ritual is interrupted.

Complete rules

Beginning the Ritual

Negation

A negated card has no effect but remains in battle and keeps its role and normal destination unless stated otherwise.

An effect cannot be negated after it resolves.

Copied effects

When instructed to resolve another card's printed effect:

- resolve only the specified effect;
- treat **you** and **your** as the player resolving it;
- treat **this card** as the card whose text is being resolved;
- pay all costs and satisfy all requirements, targets, and timing restrictions;
- do not move the source card unless instructed;
- do not reopen an earlier timing window; and
- do not choose another effect that itself resolves another effect unless expressly allowed.

18. Mystics

How it works

Mystics sacrifice, bind, exchange, and recover cards while completing three public **Rites**. The first completed Rite unlocks **Invocation**, the second unlocks **Transmutation**, and the third unlocks **Convergence** and the ability to begin the **Ritual of Ascendance**.

To win through Ritual, bind three cards from three different zones, initiate a battle while they remain bound, and win that battle.

Complete rules

Element	Mystics rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or complete the Ritual of Ascendance.
Resource	None.
Trait	All twelve Mystics cards have the Arcane trait.
Progression	First Rite: Invocation; second: Transmutation; third: Convergence and Ritual.
Leaders	Alchemist and Spirit Walker.
Unique card	Necromancy, cost 5; maximum one copy per Playable Deck.

Components and setup

A Mystics Deck includes:

- one Mystics Leader Card: **Alchemist** or **Spirit Walker**;
- one Mystics Reference Card;
- three double-sided Rite cards: **Rite of Echoes**, **Rite of Blood**, and **Rite of Crossing**; and
- any Mystics cards included in the Playable Deck.

Place all three Rite cards incomplete side up. Mystics use no resource tracker.

Rites and progression

How it works

During an Action Opportunity after movement, pay a Rite's beginning cost to begin it. You may have only one begun but incomplete Rite at a time, and a Rite cannot complete on the turn it begins.

Once its condition is met on a later turn, complete it and unlock the next faction ability. Completed Rites remain complete.

A card returned to its **source** returns to the zone from which it entered battle unless another rule gives it a different destination.

Result and destination triggers

Immediate victory triggers occur before retreat unless the effect states otherwise. Effects that require the final occupied position occur after retreat and occupation. Effects triggered by cards entering a destination occur after the cards move there.

Effects at the **end of the Aftermath** occur after normal destinations and destination-triggered effects.

Ranger



Archetype: Territory effects, reconnaissance, and field operations

Motto: *Know the land before the battle begins.*

Fieldcraft: Once per turn, when a printed Territory effect would affect you, your movement, or a battle involving you, you may spend 1 Intel to ignore that Territory effect until the end of the turn.

Fieldcraft does not alter Territory control, occupation, capture, Defender's Advantage, Last Stand bonuses, or limits calculated from Territories.

Retreat

Retreat is forced displacement after losing a battle. It is not movement or withdrawal.

Effects that trigger from movement or withdrawal do not trigger from retreat unless they say so.

During an Action Opportunity after movement, place that card face down as your Special Operation.

A Special Operation uses the printed Mission requirement but is not a normal Mission. It grants no Mission reward and does not trigger normal-Mission effects.

Readiness and completion

The Special Operation remains ready only while Operation Progress exceeds the number of Territories the opponent controls. If readiness is lost, it immediately fails and goes to the Graveyard.

During an Action Opportunity after movement, if its requirement is satisfied and readiness remains valid, reveal it and pay:

Territories currently in the Gauntlet – Special Operation card's deckbuilding value

Minimum payment is 1 Intel. If paid, immediately win through Special Operation.

Surveillance and Interference

How it works

Intelligence gets two separate chances to use Surveillance in each battle: one against an opposing Gambit and one against opposing Tactics. Spend 1 Intel for each face-down card revealed.

Immediately after revealing a card, spend 2 more Intel to interfere. The card returns to its source, and the opponent may replace it from that same source or pass.

Complete rules

Gambit Surveillance

Once per battle, after the opponent sets a face-down Gambit, spend 1 Intel to reveal it.

After you resolve any Interference against that revealed Gambit and the opponent makes any replacement, you may revise your own Gambit choice if you have already made one. Revision does not create another Surveillance or Interference opportunity.

Tactic Surveillance

Once per battle, after the opponent chooses one or more face-down Tactics, spend 1 Intel for each opposing Tactic you reveal.

After you resolve any Interference against those revealed Tactics and the opponent makes replacements, you may revise your own Tactic choices if you have already made them. Revision does not create another Surveillance or Interference opportunity.

The Gambit and Tactic opportunities are independent. Using one does not consume the other.

Interference after Surveillance

Immediately after revealing a card through Surveillance, spend 2 additional Intel per revealed card you remove.

- A removed Gambit returns to its owner's Hand.
- A removed Tactic returns to its owner's Reserve.

10. Running the Gauntlet

How it works

To win normally, push the opponent beyond their final Territory, capture that Territory, then advance beyond the column. This begins a **Last Stand battle**. Win that battle to run the Gauntlet and win the game.

The defender is harder to defeat in a Last Stand: Defender's Advantage means they win tied battle totals, and they separately add +1 to their battle total.

Complete rules

Forcing the opponent beyond the Gauntlet

When a player loses while occupying the final Territory at their end, they retreat beyond the Territory column. The winner occupies the final Territory.

The battle ends normally. The winner does not advance beyond the Gauntlet unless another rule explicitly permits it.

If the winner still occupies the final Territory at the start of their next turn, they capture it during the Capture step.

Last Stand battle

After capturing the opponent's final Territory, a player may advance beyond the Gauntlet during movement. If the opponent is there, this begins a Last Stand battle.

During a Last Stand battle:

- Defender's Advantage applies, so the defender wins tied battle totals; and
- the defender separately adds +1 to their battle total.

If the attacker wins, they have run the Gauntlet and immediately win the game.

If the defender wins, the attacker retreats to the final Territory. Play continues.

Territory-specific effects do not apply in a Last Stand battle unless they expressly apply beyond the Gauntlet.

17. Intelligence

How it works

Intelligence pursues hidden **Missions**, earns **Intel**, and builds **Operation Progress**. Intel lets the faction reveal an opponent's hidden battle choice through **Surveillance** and remove it through **Interference**.

Complete enough Missions to make a **Special Operation** ready, satisfy its hidden requirement, and pay its Intel cost to win.

Complete rules

Element	Intelligence rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or complete a Special Operation.
Tracked values	Intel and Operation Progress; both begin at 0.
Mission reward	1 Operation Progress and Intel equal to the Mission card's value.
Battle tools	Surveillance and Interference.
Leaders	Ranger and Spymaster.
Unique card	Sleeper Network, cost 5; maximum one copy per Playable Deck.

Components and setup

An Intelligence Deck includes:

- one Intelligence Leader Card: **Ranger** or **Spymaster**;
- one Mission Reference Card;
- one Operations Reference Card;
- one Intel Tracker;
- one Operation Progress Tracker; and
- any Intelligence cards included in the Playable Deck.

Both values begin at 0 and have no maximum. Only an Intelligence card with a printed **Mission** requirement may become an Active Mission or Special Operation.

Intel, Missions, and Special Operations

How it works

During an Action Opportunity after movement, place an eligible card face down as your Active Mission instead of playing an Action. Once you have satisfied its requirement on a later turn, use another after-movement Action Opportunity to reveal and complete it.

Faction zones

A faction may create additional named zones such as Treasury, bound cards, Mission areas, or progress tracks. Follow the rules that create them.

Executive



Archetype: Offensive acquisition, occupation, and immediate control

Motto: *Take the ground. Close the deal.*

Hostile Takeover: During an Action Opportunity after movement, if you won a battle as the attacker this turn and now occupy that enemy Territory, you may buy or buy out its Deed instead of playing a card for its Action effect. Treat the Territory as occupied but not controlled for the cost calculation. If the purchase succeeds, immediately take control of that Territory.

Financier-specific rules

Collateral

Collateral is not a separate zone. Place the collateral beneath the card or effect using it so its source and value remain visible.

- Line of Credit collateral goes to the Discard Pile after purchase.
- Margin Loan collateral returns only after repayment or a qualifying battle victory; default puts both cards in the Graveyard.
- Leveraged Buyout collateral goes to the Graveyard after purchase or instead of its normal battle destination.
- Collateral contributes payment value but does not become Capital unless stated.
- Unused collateral value is lost.

Added Territories

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A Territory added to the Gauntlet:

13. Overlays

How it works

An Overlay sits on a Territory and temporarily replaces the exposed effect beneath it. Only the top Overlay is active, but covered Overlays remain attached.

The player who controls the Territory also controls its Overlays. Ownership does not change, so a removed Overlay still goes to its owner's destination.

Complete rules

An Overlay is a persistent card attached to a Territory. It supersedes the printed effect immediately beneath it while exposed.

Unless an effect says otherwise:

- the top exposed Overlay is active;
- lower Overlays remain attached but dormant;
- a dormant Overlay's effect and expiration timer pause;
- a printed removal condition remains active while dormant;
- when the top Overlay leaves, the next becomes active, or the Territory's effect becomes active if none remain;
- the controller of the underlying Territory controls the Overlay and makes its choices;
- Overlay control changes when Territory control changes;
- Overlay ownership does not change;
- each Overlay faces the same direction as the Territory beneath it and rotates with it;
- an Overlay is not an Asset and does not count toward the Asset limit; and
- when removed, put it in its owner's Discard Pile unless stated otherwise.

On an Overlay, **you** means its current controller unless the text identifies its owner, the player who placed it, or another player.

An additional Action Opportunity permits one additional qualifying action at its legal timing. During an after-movement opportunity this may include Treasury, a Deed purchase, Play the Market, or Hostile Takeover. It does not grant movement.

turn.

Determine the winner, then gain normal Command before resolving other effects caused by that victory.

Newly gained Command may pay for an Order whose timing occurs during the Aftermath.

- Use an Order only at its printed timing.
- Spend the listed Command when the Order is used unless an effect changes the cost.
- An Order cannot be used without enough Command.
- Withdrawal has no winner, so it generates no Command and cannot satisfy a victory-dependent Order.

Complete rules

Capital and Capital Ledger

Capital cannot fall below 0. Record every gain, spend, loss, and end-turn reduction on the public Capital Ledger, including the new running Balance.

Capital limit = Territories you control + total deckbuilding value of cards in your Treasury

Capital may exceed the limit temporarily. At the end of every turn, including an opponent's turn, reduce your Capital to the current limit if necessary.

Treasury

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, place one card from your Hand face up in your Treasury.

- Treasury cards are outside normal card zones.
- They cannot be played or affected unless a rule specifically refers to Treasury.
- Each increases the Capital limit by its deckbuilding value.
- Treasury is not the Asset Bank and uses no Asset capacity.
- A card leaving Treasury immediately stops contributing to the limit.
- Treasury cards do not generate Capital by themselves.

Deeds

Each Territory currently in the Gauntlet has one Deed. A Deed is unowned or owned by a Financier.

When buying an unowned Deed, take a Deed Card from the supply and place it beside that Territory on the owner's side. In a Financier mirror, placement identifies ownership.

When buying out an opposing Financier's Deed, move its Deed Card to the buyer's side. When a Deed becomes unowned, return its card to the supply.

Deed ownership is independent of Territory occupation and control. Changing Territory control does not transfer its Deed. A Deed is not an Asset or Overlay.

Buying and buying out Deeds

During an Action Opportunity after movement, instead of playing a card for its Action effect, buy or buy out one Deed by paying its full cost.

Effects that permit several purchases resolve each purchase completely before recalculating the next cost.

Deed cost = min(Deeds you own + 1, 6) + position modifier + buyout premium

Minimum cost is 1 Capital.

Commandant



Archetype: Defense, counterattack, and control

Motto: *We hold. They break.*

Orders

Entrench — 1 Command: Before dice are rolled in a battle you did not initiate, add +1 to your battle total.

Repel — 1 Command: During the Aftermath of a battle you did not initiate and won, after the opponent's normal retreat, they retreat one additional position, if able.

Fortify — 2 Command: During the Aftermath of a battle you won while occupying an enemy-controlled Territory, capture that Territory.

Military-specific rules

Initiating battles

You initiated a battle when your movement or effect caused it to begin. A follow-up battle is a new battle with new Gambits, Reserves, Tactics, and once-per-battle opportunities.

Accepted: The opponent withdraws. You remain in or occupy the contested position. **Refused:** Add +1 to your battle total. If you win and newly ratify this Proposal, gain 2 Influence instead of 1.

Diplomatic Recognition

Stake: 2

Requirement: You must be defending a counterattack on a Territory you occupy that the opponent controlled immediately before you occupied it.

Accepted: Capture that Territory. The opponent withdraws, then draws two cards. **Refused:** If you win, capture that Territory during the Aftermath, but gain no Influence for imposing this Proposal.

Diplomat-specific rules

Multiple Proposals

Diplomatic Latitude may offer two eligible Proposals with the same Stake. Stake that amount once. Only the selected Proposal resolves or may become ratified.

Sanctions

Sanctions is a shared title series, not a separate card type.

Each Sanction identifies:

- the opponent whose refusal allowed it to enter play; and
- its owner.

Its ongoing effect and relief condition continue to refer to those identified players even if an Overlay changes control with its Territory.

15. Diplomats

How it works

Before a battle begins, a Diplomat may offer **Terms**. The Diplomat stakes Influence and presents a Proposal. The opponent may accept, preventing the battle, or refuse and fight under the Proposal's refusal effect.

Accepted or successfully imposed Proposals become Treaty Articles. Ratify five different Proposals and survive until the start of your next turn to win through the **Peace Treaty**.

Complete rules

Element	Diplomat rule
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or complete the Peace Treaty.
Resource	Influence, minimum 0 and maximum 10.
Starting value	1 Influence.
Faction procedure	Offer Terms during opening effects.
Leaders	Ambassador and Senator.
Proposal set	Nine double-sided Proposal / Treaty Article cards.
Faction pool	12 Diplomat card titles.

Components and setup

A Diplomat Deck includes:

- one Diplomat Leader Card: **Ambassador** or **Senator**;
- one Influence Tracker;
- one Diplomat Reference Card;
- nine double-sided Proposal / Treaty Article cards; and
- any Diplomat cards included in the Playable Deck.

Begin with 1 Influence. Place all nine Proposals Proposal side up.

Influence and Terms

How it works

Influence pays for negotiation and can strengthen a battle after Terms are refused. To offer Terms, choose one Proposal whose Requirement is satisfied and stake its listed Influence.

If the opponent accepts, no battle is fought. If the opponent refuses, resolve the Refused effect and continue to Gambits.

Senator



Archetype: Risk management, resilience, and imposition

Motto: *Procedure endures.*

Political Capital: Once per turn, when you would lose staked Influence after losing a battle following refused Terms, you may put up to that many cards from your Hand in your Graveyard. Recover 1 staked Influence for each card put there; lose the rest.

Proposal set

De-escalation

Stake: 0

Requirement: None

Accepted: Both players withdraw. The opponent draws one card. **Refused:** Draw one card.

Orderly Withdrawal

Stake: 0

Requirement: You must be attacking.

Accepted: You withdraw. The opponent remains in or occupies the contested position, then draws one card. **Refused:** Add +1 to your battle total.

4. resolve the battle and its Aftermath.

Apply the result:

Result	Stake	Ratification	Normal reward
Diplomat wins	Return	If new, impose and flip	Gain 1 Influence unless stated otherwise
Diplomat loses	Lose	None	None
No winner	Return	None	None

To **impose** a Proposal is to ratify it after winning the battle caused by its refusal.

Withdrawal produces no winner. Return the Stake and do not impose the Proposal.

Leverage

Before dice are rolled in a battle following refused Terms, the Diplomat may spend any amount of available Influence. Add +1 to the Diplomat's battle total for each Influence spent.

Staked Influence cannot be spent as Leverage.

Treaty Articles and Peace Treaty

A ratified Proposal is a Treaty Article. It may be offered again for its tactical effects but cannot be ratified again and grants no normal newly-ratified Influence reward.

At the start of the Diplomat's turn, after the Capture step and before the Draw step, if five different Proposals are ratified, the Diplomat wins through the Peace Treaty.